

Olympiad Test Paper — Social Science (Class 7) — Paper 5

Chapter 9: From the Rulers to the Ruled: Types of Governments

Paper 5 — (progressively harder)

Subject	Social Science (NCERT Class 7)
Chapter	9 — From the Rulers to the Ruled: Types of Governments
Total Questions	60 (Multiple Choice, single correct)
Maximum Marks	240
Suggested Time	90 minutes

Marking scheme: +4 for each correct answer · -1 for each wrong answer · 0 if unattempted.

Instructions: Each question has four options (A), (B), (C), (D); exactly one is correct. Apex traps reward students who reason from definitions through layered scenarios rather than from surface labels: a label that fits one feature can still be wrong overall, several distinct labels can describe the very same country, and the absence of any single democratic pillar can quietly hollow out an election. Do not write on this paper — mark answers on your answer sheet.

1. A new state writes a constitution that lists three named bodies: one drafts and votes on statutes, one runs the daily administration and commands officials, and one hears disputes about whether actions break those statutes. A reform later merges all three into one office held by a single person. The reform most directly destroys which safeguard, and what is the chief danger?

- (A) Separation of powers; with lawmaking, enforcement and judging in one hand, nothing remains to check that single office, so power can be abused without limit
- (B) Universal adult franchise; the merger removes the right of every adult to vote in elections
- (C) The principle of accountability through a free press; the merger silences newspapers directly
- (D) Judicial review of elections; the merger ends the holding of elections rather than affecting any organ's independence

2. In Country A the assembly debates a bill, votes it into law, and the administration then enforces it; a citizen challenges the enforcement and a court rules the enforcement

unlawful. Mapping each step to a function, which sequence is correct?

- (A) Debating and voting the bill is executive; enforcing it is legislative; the court ruling is judicial
- (B) Debating and voting the bill is legislative; enforcing it is executive; the court ruling on its lawfulness is judicial
- (C) Debating and voting the bill is legislative; enforcing it is judicial; the court ruling is executive
- (D) All three steps are legislative because they all concern a single law

3. A reformer proposes that the same elected assembly should both pass laws and also be the final court that decides whether those laws were broken, arguing this is 'more efficient'. Why does the textbook's reasoning treat this as a threat to democracy rather than an improvement?

- (A) Because efficiency is forbidden in a democracy, so any efficient design is automatically undemocratic
- (B) If the body that makes laws also judges disputes about them, no independent organ can check it, so the assembly could shield its own wrongdoing and abuse power
- (C) Because an assembly is never allowed to pass laws at all in a democracy
- (D) Because the judiciary is supposed to make the laws and the legislature is supposed to judge disputes

4. Three friends each define the judiciary differently. The accurate one says the judiciary should be able to rule against the very government that funds it. Why is that independence, rather than loyalty to the government, the democratic ideal?

- (A) Because the judiciary's real job is to pass new laws whenever the government's laws are unpopular
- (B) Only a court free to decide against the government can ensure that even the rulers are held to the law and that citizens' rights are upheld
- (C) Because a court that always sided with the government would make decisions faster and that speed is the goal
- (D) Because the judiciary in a democracy is meant only to advise a monarch and never to decide cases

5. A country's written rules say all three organs exist, but in practice the head of the executive personally appoints and dismisses every judge and can rewrite any law overnight. A student insists 'it has separation of powers because the constitution names three organs.' What is the strongest correction?

- (A) The student is right, because a constitution that names three organs guarantees separation of powers
- (B) The country has separation of powers only because it still holds elections for the executive

(C) Naming three organs on paper is not enough; separation of powers requires that each organ act independently, which is missing once one person controls lawmaking and the judges

(D) Separation of powers is irrelevant here because the country has a written constitution

6. A monarch in Country B opens parliament each year and signs every bill, but never refuses a bill, never drafts one, and cannot remove the elected ministers. The day-to-day decisions are taken by ministers answerable to the elected house. Identify the form, and the function the monarch is actually performing.

(A) A constitutional monarchy that is also a parliamentary democracy; the monarch performs a nominal, ceremonial role while the elected executive really governs

(B) An absolute monarchy; signing every bill proves the monarch personally makes the laws

(C) A presidential democracy; the monarch is a separately elected head independent of the legislature

(D) A theocracy; the monarch's ceremonial duties show the state is run by religious ritual

7. Two countries both have a king. In the first, the king issues decrees that no court or assembly may overturn; in the second, the king's assent is automatic and an elected parliament makes and is answerable for the laws. A claim says 'both prove that having a king rules out democracy.' Evaluate it.

(A) The claim is true, because any king at all makes a country undemocratic

(B) The claim is true for the second country only, because automatic assent means the king secretly rules

(C) The claim is false; the first is an absolute monarchy that is not a democracy, but the second is a constitutional monarchy that is a parliamentary democracy, so a king does not by itself rule out democracy

(D) The claim is false because both kings are actually elected by the people

8. Saudi Arabia and the United Kingdom both have monarchs, yet only the UK is also a democracy. A student must explain the difference using only the meanings of 'absolute' and 'constitutional'. Which explanation is fully correct?

(A) Both monarchs reign only ceremonially, so the difference lies entirely in the size of each country

(B) The UK is a democracy because its monarch is elected, while Saudi Arabia's monarch inherits the throne

(C) Saudi Arabia is the democracy because an absolute monarch can act faster on the people's wishes

(D) In Saudi Arabia the monarch actually exercises ruling power (absolute), while in the UK the monarch is nominal and an elected parliament governs (constitutional), and only the latter is a democracy

9. A country abolishes its hereditary throne, declares that its head of state will henceforth be elected for a fixed term, but continues to let only a small landowning class vote and jails anyone who criticises the rulers. Using strictly the textbook definitions, which single label is now unquestionably accurate, and why is 'democracy' not yet earned?

(A) Democracy, because abolishing the hereditary throne by itself establishes rule by the people

(B) Republic, because the head of state is now elected rather than hereditary; democracy is not earned because rule by the people also needs universal franchise, free criticism and protected rights, which are absent

(C) Constitutional monarchy, because an elected head of state has simply replaced the king

(D) Direct democracy, because the citizens themselves now select the head of state

10. A debater argues: 'Every republic is a democracy and every democracy is a republic, since both mean the people rule.' Identify the precise flaw using the two definitions.

(A) There is no flaw; the two words are exact synonyms in every case

(B) The flaw is that a republic actually requires a hereditary king while a democracy forbids one

(C) The terms overlap but are not identical: democracy is about the people ruling, while a republic specifically means the head of state is elected rather than hereditary, so a constitutional-monarchy democracy is a democracy that is not a republic

(D) The flaw is that democracy concerns an elected head of state while a republic concerns rule by the whole people

11. A constitutional monarchy and a republic are compared, and both are democracies. Which single feature reliably tells them apart, and which features do NOT?

(A) The decisive feature is that only the republic holds elections, while the constitutional monarchy holds none

(B) The decisive feature is whether the head of state is hereditary (constitutional monarchy) or elected (republic); holding elections, protecting rights, and having a parliament are shared by both

(C) The decisive feature is that only the constitutional monarchy protects fundamental rights

(D) The decisive feature is that the republic keeps a hereditary head while the constitutional monarchy elects its head

12. India keeps a President as head of state yet is called a parliamentary democracy and a democratic republic at the same time. Which combined explanation correctly reconciles all three descriptions?

- (A) India is presidential because it has a President, and a republic because the President is hereditary, but it is not truly a democracy
- (B) India is a republic because its head of state is elected, not hereditary; it is parliamentary because real executive power lies with the Prime Minister and Council of Ministers who must keep Parliament's confidence; and it is a democracy because the people rule through elected representatives
- (C) India is a constitutional monarchy because the President signs laws like a king, and therefore not a republic
- (D) India is a direct democracy because every citizen votes on each law, which is why it needs no Prime Minister

13. In a presidential system the head of government is separately elected for a fixed term; in a parliamentary system the head of government is drawn from the legislature and can be removed if it loses the legislature's confidence. A country's leader is chosen by the elected lower house and resigns the moment that house withdraws support. The country is best classified as, and the decisive clue is:

- (A) A presidential system, because the leader was chosen through an election of some kind
- (B) An absolute monarchy, because a single leader heads the government
- (C) A parliamentary system, decisively because the head of government depends on and can be removed by the legislature's confidence
- (D) A theocracy, because the lower house withdrew support as a religious ritual

14. If India's Lok Sabha passes a vote of no confidence in the government, the most accurate consequence, and what it reveals about the system, is:

- (A) Nothing changes, revealing that India's executive is elected separately for a fixed term like a president
- (B) The Council of Ministers headed by the Prime Minister must resign, revealing that in a parliamentary system the executive survives only while it holds the legislature's confidence
- (C) The President is automatically removed, revealing that the head of state depends on the legislature's confidence
- (D) The Supreme Court must dissolve and appoint a new government, revealing that the judiciary controls the executive

15. A student claims, 'Because India copied a written constitution from elsewhere, its President must run the country exactly as the US President does.' Which correction is most precise about both systems?

- (A) Unlike the US President, who is separately elected and is the real head of government, India's President is largely nominal, and the country is actually run by the Prime Minister and Council of Ministers answerable to Parliament
- (B) The student is right, because both Presidents are the real heads of government with identical powers
- (C) India has no Prime Minister, so its President must in fact run everything just as the US President does
- (D) India's President is directly elected by all voters exactly like the US President and rules independently

16. Two democracies differ in one structural way: in the first, the same election fills the legislature and from it emerges the head of government, who falls if the legislature turns against them; in the second, voters cast separate ballots for the legislature and for a head of government who serves a fixed term whatever the legislature thinks. These are, in order:

- (A) A presidential system and a parliamentary system
- (B) A parliamentary system and a presidential system
- (C) A constitutional monarchy and a republic
- (D) A direct democracy and a representative democracy

17. A small village gathers all its adult residents in the square and they personally vote yes or no on repairing the well; the national capital, meanwhile, has an elected assembly debate and pass the year's budget. These two decisions illustrate, in order:

- (A) Representative democracy and direct democracy
- (B) A referendum on the budget and an election of the village head
- (C) Oligarchy and constitutional monarchy
- (D) Direct democracy and representative democracy

18. A referendum and the election of a member of the assembly are both votes, yet they differ in kind. A country puts a single specific question, 'Should the drinking-water tax be doubled?', directly to all citizens. This is a referendum rather than an ordinary election because:

- (A) Only the members of the existing assembly are permitted to vote on the tax question
- (B) A panel of judges casts the deciding ballots on the citizens' behalf
- (C) Citizens are deciding a specific question themselves rather than choosing a person to decide such questions for them
- (D) The head of state announces the result after privately consulting wealthy families

19. A class of forty used to let everyone vote on each matter; it now elects three monitors to decide and report back. A second class scraps its monitors and returns to everyone voting on each matter. These two shifts model, in order, moves from:

- (A) Representative democracy to direct democracy, then direct democracy to oligarchy
- (B) Democracy to monarchy, then monarchy to republic

- (C) Direct democracy to oligarchy, then oligarchy to dictatorship
- (D) Direct democracy to representative democracy, then representative democracy back to direct democracy

20. What is the common thread that still makes BOTH a direct democracy and a representative democracy genuine 'democracies', despite their visible differences?

- (A) In both, ultimate power is vested in a hereditary monarch who reigns for life
- (B) In both, citizens are forbidden to vote and all decisions are left to appointed officials
- (C) In both, ultimate power rests with the people, whether they decide issues themselves or through representatives they choose and can replace
- (D) In both, every decision must first be approved by religious leaders

21. A country holds a vote every five years, but only one party may appear on the ballot, the courts obey that party, and criticising leaders is a crime. A poster calls it a 'people's democracy'. Using the textbook's pillars, the most accurate classification and reason is:

- (A) A genuine democracy, because it holds a scheduled vote every five years
- (B) A republic, and therefore automatically a full democracy as well
- (C) A dictatorship dressed in democratic language, because real power is unchecked and the people cannot genuinely choose or remove their rulers
- (D) A direct democracy, because the people personally cast votes

22. Country X holds free elections, lets courts rule against the government, and protects critics; Country Y holds elections too, but one party controls the judges, jails critics and bans rival parties. A judge of 'which is more truly a democracy' should reason:

- (A) Country X, because democracy requires not only elections but also rule of law, an independent judiciary and protected freedoms, all of which Y lacks
- (B) Country Y, because holding regular elections is by itself the complete test of a democracy
- (C) Both equally, because each holds elections on a schedule
- (D) Neither, because a true democracy forbids the existence of organised political parties

23. A government wins the most votes, then declares 'the majority chose us, so the law no longer applies to us and we may strip troublesome minorities of their rights.' The strongest single constitutional response is:

- (A) A winning majority does indeed free leaders from legal limits and lets them remove any rights it dislikes
- (B) Only the courts, and never the constitution itself, can ever limit an elected government

(C) Winning a majority automatically suspends fundamental rights until the next election

(D) A majority mandate does not place leaders above the law or permit violating fundamental rights; rule of law and the constitution bind even an elected government, and protected rights cannot be voted away

24. Assertion: A winning majority may pass any law it likes, including one removing a minority's fundamental rights. Reason: Democracy means majority rule. Choose the most accurate option.

(A) Both the assertion and the reason are fully true, and the reason explains the assertion

(B) Both are false, because democracy involves no majority decisions at all

(C) The assertion is false, while the reason is partly true but incomplete; democracy is majority rule limited by protected rights, so a majority cannot vote away fundamental rights

(D) The assertion is true, but the reason is false because democracy never involves the majority

25. Which newly introduced feature would move a country FURTHER from democracy rather than closer to it?

(A) Placing all courts under the direct command of the ruling party

(B) Extending the right to vote to every adult citizen

(C) Guaranteeing citizens the freedom to criticise the government

(D) Allowing an independent court to overturn unlawful government actions

26. A country guarantees free speech and equality in its constitution and lets an independent court enforce them against the government, yet no elections are ever held and citizens never choose or remove the rulers. Which pillar of democracy is most clearly still MISSING?

(A) Protection of fundamental rights such as free speech

(B) An independent judiciary able to check the government

(C) Equality of citizens before the law

(D) Free and fair elections through which the people choose and can remove their rulers

27. Country M has genuine free and fair elections and an independent judiciary, but its constitution bars one religious community from voting or standing for office. Which core democratic principle does this most directly violate, even though elections are real?

(A) Separation of powers, since barring a community changes how the three organs relate to one another

(B) Equality of citizens, since some citizens are denied the equal right to choose and join the government

- (C) The rule that a head of state must be elected rather than hereditary
- (D) The requirement that the country hold a referendum on every major law

28. 'Accountability' is offered as a reason democracy outperforms dictatorship. Which statement captures accountability most precisely as the chapter uses it?

- (A) The government is free from any questioning by the citizens it governs
- (B) The government is answerable only to a foreign power rather than to its own people
- (C) The government is answerable to the people who elected it and can be removed by them through free elections, a check a dictator does not face
- (D) The government may overrule the courts whenever it disagrees with their decisions

29. A single ruler seizes power by force, faces no constitution, no court that can rule against him, and no election he can lose. A student labels this a 'monarchy because one person rules.' Why is 'dictatorship' the correct label and 'monarchy' wrong?

- (A) It is a monarchy, because any single all-powerful ruler is automatically a monarch
- (B) It is a theocracy, because unchecked power must rest on a religious claim
- (C) It is a dictatorship because one person holds absolute, unchecked power; monarchy is wrong because monarchy means power inherited within a family, whereas this ruler seized power and faces no limits
- (D) It is an oligarchy, because absolute power always belongs to a group rather than one person

30. In an absolute monarchy and a dictatorship the deepest shared feature, beneath their different origins, is that:

- (A) Both choose their ruler through universal adult franchise
- (B) One person holds power with no genuine accountability to the people and no real limits from law
- (C) Both keep the ruler's power purely ceremonial while an elected body governs
- (D) Both require the ruler to step down whenever a court rules against him

31. Two states each keep power from the broad public. In the first, five wealthy families together run everything and pass laws protecting their fortunes; in the second, one general rules alone with no limits. These are, in order, and what distinguishes them is:

- (A) A dictatorship and an oligarchy; the first has a group and the second has one ruler
- (B) An oligarchy and a dictatorship; the oligarchy concentrates power in a small group, while the dictatorship concentrates it in one unchecked person
- (C) A republic and a constitutional monarchy; both simply have small leadership
- (D) A theocracy and a direct democracy; one is religious and the other lets citizens vote

32. Which set lists three forms of government that ALL concentrate power in a small number of rulers rather than spreading it among the people?

- (A) Absolute monarchy, dictatorship, oligarchy
- (B) Representative democracy, direct democracy, republic

- (C) Direct democracy, oligarchy, constitutional monarchy
- (D) Republic, theocracy, representative democracy

33. A country is governed by clerics who apply sacred religious law over all ordinary lawmaking. Four labels are proposed; which one is the odd one out because it does NOT fit this description?

- (A) Theocracy
- (B) A government where religious leaders hold authority
- (C) A state where sacred law overrides ordinary lawmaking
- (D) Oligarchy

34. Greek roots help decode the names of government forms. Which single pairing of word and root meaning is correct?

- (A) Monarchy: 'many' plus 'rule'
- (B) Oligarchy: 'few' plus 'rule'
- (C) Democracy: 'god' plus 'power'
- (D) Theocracy: 'one' plus 'rule'

35. A debater says, 'A dictatorship just has one decisive leader, so it is really the fastest kind of democracy.' What is the strongest correction?

- (A) The claim is correct, since speed of decision is what mainly defines a democracy
- (B) A dictatorship is not a democracy at all, fast or slow, because its ruler holds unchecked power and is not accountable to the people, who cannot remove him
- (C) A dictatorship is a democracy only when the dictator also happens to win an election
- (D) A dictatorship is really a constitutional monarchy, so the word 'democracy' simply does not apply

36. A real, healthy democracy can still 'drift toward oligarchy' over time. Which development would most clearly signal that drift?

- (A) More ordinary citizens turn out to vote in each election
- (B) The courts become more independent of the ruling government
- (C) Fundamental rights become better protected for everyone
- (D) A small powerful group gains so much control that ordinary citizens' votes stop genuinely shaping decisions

37. Which single feature, present in a genuine democracy, is the one reliably ABSENT in a dictatorship?

- (A) Genuine accountability of rulers to the people, who can replace them through free elections
- (B) A capital city from which the government operates
- (C) Armed forces that defend the country's borders
- (D) A national flag and a national anthem

38. Which combination of features, taken together, most reliably marks a country as a genuine democracy rather than merely an election-holding state?

- (A) A large army, a long history, and a single long-ruling family
- (B) Regular votes only, with no protected rights and no independent courts
- (C) Free and fair elections, equality before the law, protected fundamental rights, and an independent judiciary
- (D) Rule by religious law alone, with leaders chosen by the clergy

39. A queen signs every law and opens parliament yearly, but an elected parliament debates, decides and is answerable for those laws while she may not refuse them. Her country is best classified as:

- (A) An absolute monarchy, because the queen signs every law
- (B) A dictatorship, because one person sits at the top of the state
- (C) A theocracy, because the queen is treated with ceremonial reverence
- (D) A constitutional monarchy that is also a parliamentary democracy

40. Assertion: A country can be both a monarchy and a democracy at the same time.

Reason: In a constitutional monarchy the monarch's powers are largely nominal while an elected parliament governs. Choose the correct option.

- (A) Both are true, but the reason does not explain the assertion
- (B) The assertion is true but the reason is false
- (C) Both the assertion and the reason are true, and the reason correctly explains the assertion
- (D) The assertion is false but the reason is true

41. A king personally issues laws, commands the army and judges disputes himself, with no elected body able to overrule him. Identify the form and explain why the alternative monarchy label is wrong.

- (A) A constitutional monarchy, because any country with a king is constitutional by definition
- (B) An absolute monarchy, because the king actually exercises all power; not a constitutional monarchy, where the monarch would be nominal and an elected parliament would govern
- (C) A republic, because the king is the one making the final decisions on laws
- (D) A direct democracy, because the king decides matters quickly and personally

42. Why is it accurate to call the UK a democracy even though it has never elected its monarch?

- (A) The monarch's role is nominal, and the country is actually governed by a parliament that the people elect
- (B) Because the monarch is secretly elected by the people each term
- (C) Because the monarch personally makes all the laws after winning a vote
- (D) Because simply having any monarch automatically makes a country democratic

- 43.** The three organs of government are correctly matched to their core functions in which option?
- (A) Legislature makes laws; executive carries them out; judiciary settles disputes and ensures laws are followed
 - (B) Legislature carries out laws; executive settles disputes; judiciary makes laws
 - (C) Legislature settles disputes; executive makes laws; judiciary carries them out
 - (D) Legislature, executive and judiciary all only make laws
- 44.** A court strikes down a government order because the order breaks the law. Which function is at work, and why is it NOT the executive function?
- (A) The legislative function, because the court is effectively writing a brand-new law
 - (B) The executive function, because the court is enforcing the government's will
 - (C) The judicial function, because interpreting law and judging whether an act is lawful is judicial; the executive's job is to carry out laws, not to judge them
 - (D) A ceremonial function, because striking down an order is only a symbolic act
- 45.** A new country wants to ensure no single leader can dominate the state. Which design choice best serves that goal, and why do the others fail it?
- (A) Dividing power among an independent legislature, executive and judiciary so each checks the others
 - (B) Letting one elected leader also appoint all the judges and control lawmaking
 - (C) Abolishing the courts so that decisions can be made more quickly
 - (D) Giving the army authority over both the legislature and the judiciary
- 46.** The 'Peek into History' offers the Vajji, ancient Greece and ancient Rome. Taken together, what is the central point these examples are meant to establish?
- (A) The idea of the ruled choosing their rulers is ancient and arose in several civilisations, not only in modern times
 - (B) Democracy was invented entirely in the twenty-first century
 - (C) Only one civilisation in all of history ever attempted any form of self-rule
 - (D) Holding elections was impossible before the modern age
- 47.** The Lichchhavi clan, an early Indian example of people choosing their leaders, belonged to which confederation, and what does this membership illustrate?
- (A) The Magadha empire of the Mauryas, illustrating rule by inherited kings
 - (B) The Chola kingdom of the south, illustrating the Uttaramerur election records
 - (C) The Kushana empire of the northwest, illustrating rule by foreign conquerors
 - (D) The Vajji, illustrating that choosing leaders rather than simply inheriting power existed in ancient India
- 48.** The Uttaramerur inscriptions are tied to the Cholas. Their main historical value, as the chapter uses them, is that they show:

- (A) India held no elections of any kind before modern times
- (B) Only hereditary kings ever held power throughout Indian history
- (C) Organised elections to choose local representatives existed in early India
- (D) Elections were a practice found only in ancient Greece

49. A country's head of state is selected by a nationwide vote, serves a fixed four-year term, has no king or queen, but the constitution also bars all opposition parties and lets the head jail critics. Which two statements are BOTH true?

- (A) It is a republic because the head of state is elected and non-hereditary, but it is not a genuine democracy because opposition and free criticism are crushed
- (B) It is a democracy because the head of state is elected, and it is not a republic because it lacks a king
- (C) It is a constitutional monarchy because the head serves a fixed term, and it is also a full democracy
- (D) It is a direct democracy because citizens voted for the head, and a theocracy because critics are jailed

50. Country R is a constitutional monarchy and a parliamentary democracy; Country S is a presidential democratic republic. A student claims 'R cannot be a democracy because it has a monarch, and S cannot be a republic because it has a powerful president.' What is the correct rebuttal of BOTH claims?

- (A) Both claims are right; any monarch ends democracy and any strong president ends a republic
- (B) R is a democracy but S is not a republic, because a republic must have a weak president
- (C) Neither R nor S is a democracy, because only direct democracies count as democracies
- (D) R is a democracy because its elected parliament governs under a nominal monarch, and S is a republic because its head of state is elected rather than hereditary; a monarch does not bar democracy and a powerful president does not bar a republic

51. A nation holds vigorous free elections and protects speech, but a small circle of billionaire families quietly funds all major parties, owns the newspapers and effectively decides every important policy regardless of who wins. The most accurate description and reasoning is:

- (A) An oligarchy operating behind a democratic appearance, because real decisions rest with a small powerful group rather than with the people, despite the elections
- (B) A healthy, fully functioning democracy, because elections are free and speech is protected
- (C) A constitutional monarchy, because a small elite stands above the elected leaders
- (D) A direct democracy, because citizens cast votes in the elections

52. A country lays three claims: 'our head of state is elected, so we are a republic; our parliament makes the laws, so we are a democracy; our army may overrule any court, so disputes get settled fast.' Which claim quietly contradicts the democratic label the country wants?

- (A) Having an elected head of state contradicts being a republic
- (B) Letting parliament make the laws contradicts being a democracy
- (C) Settling disputes quickly is itself the defining feature of a democracy, so nothing is contradicted
- (D) Letting the army overrule any court destroys judicial independence and rule of law, which contradicts the country's claim to be a genuine democracy

53. A reformer wants to convert a parliamentary democracy into a presidential one but keep it a democracy and a republic. Which single change is essential, and which would wrongly destroy a feature he wants to keep?

- (A) Essential: make the head of state hereditary; he must not hold any elections, which would end the democracy
- (B) Essential: make the head of government separately elected for a fixed term independent of the legislature; he must NOT make the head of state hereditary, which would end the republic
- (C) Essential: abolish the legislature entirely; he must not keep an independent judiciary, which slows decisions
- (D) Essential: hand all three organs to one person; he must not allow free criticism, which causes disorder

54. A government that openly answers questions in an elected assembly, can be voted out, and obeys court rulings against it is contrasted with one whose leader answers to no assembly, cannot be voted out, and ignores the courts. Beyond elections, the single principle most sharply dividing them is:

- (A) The size of the population, since only large countries can hold leaders accountable
- (B) The presence of a national army, since only the first government can defend its borders
- (C) Accountability under the rule of law: in the first, even rulers are answerable and bound by law and can be removed; in the second, the leader is unaccountable and above the law
- (D) The age of the country, since only older countries develop accountable leaders

55. Country J: hereditary head of state, elected parliament makes laws, courts can rule against ministers. Country K: elected head of state, single party, courts obey rulers. Classify each on the monarchy/republic axis AND the democracy axis.

- (A) J is a republic and a democracy; K is a constitutional monarchy and a democracy
- (B) J is an absolute monarchy and not a democracy; K is a republic and a full democracy

- (C) Both are democracies and both are republics, since each has elections of some kind
(D) J is a constitutional monarchy and a democracy; K is a republic but not a genuine democracy

56. An exam asks for the form where power is most clearly passed down within a single family by birth, contrasting it with three forms that do not work that way. The correct answer is monarchy because:

- (A) Oligarchy, because a small group always inherits power within one bloodline
(B) Republic, because its elected head of state passes the office to a chosen heir
(C) Representative democracy, because elected representatives inherit their seats from parents
(D) Monarchy means the ruler is a king or queen who usually inherits the position within the family, whereas a republic, a representative democracy and an oligarchy do not pass the top office down by birth

57. A teacher says, 'Holding an election is necessary but not sufficient for democracy.' Which scenario best demonstrates the 'not sufficient' half of that statement?

- (A) A country votes on schedule, but critics are jailed, rival parties are banned and the courts always side with the rulers
(B) A country votes, and opposition parties campaign openly and sometimes win
(C) A country votes, and independent courts can overturn unlawful government actions
(D) A country votes, and minorities enjoy the same legal rights as the majority

58. Despite acknowledging its flaws, the chapter reaches an overall verdict about democracy. That verdict is best stated as:

- (A) Democracy is the rarest form of government found on Earth
(B) Democracy is a system that no country actually puts into practice
(C) Democracy is identical in practice to a dictatorship
(D) Democracy, though imperfect, is the most popular form of government in the world today

59. Four countries are described only by who really holds power: in W the people choose and can remove rulers under protected rights; in X a hereditary king truly governs unchecked; in Y one seized leader rules with no limits; in Z five families control all decisions. Match all four to their forms.

- (A) W is an oligarchy, X is a democracy, Y is a constitutional monarchy, and Z is a dictatorship
(B) W is a dictatorship, X is a republic, Y is a democracy, and Z is a theocracy
(C) W is a constitutional monarchy, X is a dictatorship, Y is an oligarchy, and Z is a democracy
(D) W is a democracy, X is an absolute monarchy, Y is a dictatorship, and Z is an oligarchy

60. A country's defenders argue, 'We are a real democracy: our majority can pass any law, our President is elected so we are a republic, and we hold a vote every term.' A critic notes the majority recently stripped a minority of its rights and the courts could not stop it.

Which conclusion is most accurate?

- (A) It is a republic with elections, but stripping a minority's protected rights without any check shows it is failing as a genuine democracy, since a majority cannot lawfully vote away fundamental rights
- (B) It is a full democracy, because a majority in a democracy may pass any law it wishes
- (C) It is not a republic, because a true republic forbids the majority from ever deciding anything
- (D) It is a dictatorship, because holding regular elections is proof of dictatorship

Solutions — Social Science (Class 7), Chapter 9: From the Rulers to the Ruled: Types of Governments — Paper 5

Paper 5 — (progressively harder)

Marking: +4 correct, -1 wrong, 0 unattempted. Maximum marks **240**.

Answer Key

Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans
1	A	11	B	21	C	31	B	41	B	51	A
2	B	12	B	22	A	32	A	42	A	52	D
3	B	13	C	23	D	33	D	43	A	53	B
4	B	14	B	24	C	34	B	44	C	54	C
5	C	15	A	25	A	35	B	45	A	55	D
6	A	16	B	26	D	36	D	46	A	56	D
7	C	17	D	27	B	37	A	47	D	57	A
8	D	18	C	28	C	38	C	48	C	58	D
9	B	19	D	29	C	39	D	49	A	59	D
10	C	20	C	30	B	40	C	50	D	60	A

Answer-key distribution: A = 15, B = 15, C = 15, D = 15.

Worked Solutions

1. (A) The constitution had described the legislature, executive and judiciary, and keeping them in separate hands is exactly the separation of powers; collapsing all three into one office removes the mutual checks and lets that office abuse power unchecked. The franchise concerns who may vote, not how the organs are arranged, so it is untouched by merging the organs. A free press is a different safeguard and is not what the three named bodies represent. Judicial review of elections is a narrow court power, not the broad structural division being dismantled here.

2. (B) Making law by debate and vote is the legislative function, carrying it out is the executive function, and deciding whether the action was lawful is the judicial function, so the first mapping is exact. Swapping legislative and executive labels misnames the assembly's lawmaking as administration. Calling enforcement judicial and the court ruling executive reverses the carry-out and judge roles. Lumping all three as legislative ignores

that only the debate-and-vote step is lawmaking while the others are enforcement and judging.

3. (B) Letting one body both legislate and judge removes the independent judicial check, so the assembly could rule in its own favour and abuse power; that is why separation of powers matters. Democracy does not forbid efficiency; it limits how power is concentrated. A legislature making laws is normal and proper, so that is not the objection. The judiciary's job is to judge and the legislature's is to make laws, so the last option reverses their roles.

4. (B) An independent court that can rule against the government keeps even rulers bound by law and protects rights, which is why independence is the ideal. Making new laws is the legislature's task, not the court's, so that misstates the judicial role. A court that always backs the government would simply rubber-stamp it, defeating the purpose, and speed is not the democratic value at stake. Advising a monarch describes a nominal role under a king, not the active deciding role of a democratic judiciary.

5. (C) Separation of powers is about each organ actually functioning independently, so a head who controls the judges and rewrites laws has destroyed it regardless of what the document lists. Merely naming three organs does not guarantee their independence, so the student's claim fails. Holding executive elections does not restore independence to courts the executive controls. Having a written constitution does not by itself secure separation of powers if the text is ignored in practice.

6. (A) A monarch who only signs without ever refusing, while elected ministers answerable to the house govern, holds nominal power, which is the constitutional monarchy that doubles as a parliamentary democracy. Signing bills mechanically is not making law, so the absolute-monarchy reading is wrong. A monarch is not a separately elected president, so it is not a presidential system. Ceremony is not religious rule, so theocracy does not fit.

7. (C) Whether a monarchy is a democracy turns on who really governs, so the absolute case is not a democracy while the constitutional case is, making the blanket claim false. A king does not automatically end democracy, so the first option is wrong. Automatic assent signals a nominal monarch, not a secret ruler, so the second misreads it. Neither king is elected, so the last option invents a false fact.

8. (D) The contrast is that an absolute monarch truly governs while a constitutional monarch is nominal under an elected parliament, and only the elected-parliament case is a democracy. They do not both reign ceremonially, so country size is not the difference. The UK monarch is not elected; the country is a democracy because parliament is elected, not the monarch. An absolute monarch acting fast is not democratic accountability, so the last option is wrong.

9. (B) An elected, non-hereditary head of state is exactly what makes a republic, so that label is secured; democracy needs broad voting rights, free speech and protected rights, which are missing, so it is not yet earned. Abolishing a throne does not by itself create rule by the people. A constitutional monarchy keeps a monarch, but the throne is gone, so that label is impossible. The narrow landowning electorate is not the whole people deciding directly, so it is not a direct democracy.

10. (C) Democracy describes the people ruling and a republic adds the specific requirement of an elected, non-hereditary head of state; a constitutional-monarchy democracy keeps a hereditary head so it is a democracy but not a republic, proving the two are not identical. They are not exact synonyms, so the first option fails. A republic requires an elected, not hereditary, head, so the second reverses the meaning. The third swaps the two definitions entirely.

11. (B) Both can be democracies, so they share elections, protected rights and parliaments; what separates them is whether the head of state inherits the office or is elected. The constitutional monarchy still holds elections for its parliament, so 'only the republic holds elections' is false. Both protect rights, so that is not the divider. The last option reverses which one has the hereditary head.

12. (B) An elected head of state makes it a republic, the PM and Council answerable to Parliament make it parliamentary, and rule by elected representatives makes it a democracy, so all three labels hold together. Having a President does not make a system presidential, and India's President is elected not hereditary, so the first option is wrong on two counts. A President is not a hereditary monarch, so the constitutional-monarchy reading fails. India elects representatives rather than voting on every law, so it is not a direct democracy.

13. (C) A head of government who comes from the elected house and falls when it withdraws confidence is the defining mark of a parliamentary system. Being chosen through some election does not make it presidential, since presidential heads are elected separately and serve fixed terms regardless of the legislature. One leader heading a government does not make a monarchy, which requires inherited rule. Withdrawing legislative support is a political act, not a religious one, so theocracy does not fit.

14. (B) Loss of confidence forces the PM and Council to resign, which shows the executive depends on the legislature, the hallmark of a parliamentary system. The executive is not separately elected for a fixed term in India, so 'nothing changes' is wrong. The President is the nominal head and is not removed by such a vote. The judiciary neither dissolves itself nor appoints governments, so the last option misstates its role.

15. (A) The US President is the real executive elected separately, whereas India's President is nominal and the PM and Council govern answerable to Parliament, so the systems differ sharply. The two Presidents do not have identical powers, so the student is

not right. India does have a Prime Minister who really governs, so the second option is false. India's President is not chosen the same way as the US President and does not rule independently, so the last option is wrong.

16. (B) A head of government emerging from the legislature and removable by it is parliamentary, while a separately elected head serving a fixed term is presidential, so the order is parliamentary then presidential. Reversing them mislabels each. Neither description turns on a hereditary versus elected head of state, so the monarchy-versus-republic pairing is irrelevant. Both involve elected representatives rather than citizens voting on every issue, so the direct-versus-representative pairing does not apply.

17. (D) Residents deciding the well themselves is direct democracy, while an elected assembly passing the budget is representative democracy, so the order is direct then representative. Reversing them mislabels each scene. Neither scene is a national referendum or a village-head election, so that pairing misdescribes both. Neither involves a small ruling clique or a monarch, so oligarchy and constitutional monarchy do not fit.

18. (C) A referendum lets citizens settle a specific question directly, unlike an election where they pick a representative to decide for them. Restricting the vote to assembly members would make it an internal assembly vote, not a referendum of citizens. Judges do not cast referendum ballots for citizens. A head of state consulting wealthy families is not a citizen vote at all, so that misdescribes a referendum.

19. (D) Everyone voting is direct democracy and electing monitors to decide is representative democracy, so the first class moves direct-to-representative and the second reverses it. The first option mislabels the first move. Electing monitors is not creating a monarch, so the monarchy-republic pairing fails. Three elected, reporting monitors are accountable representatives, not an unaccountable ruling clique, so neither move becomes an oligarchy or dictatorship.

20. (C) Both forms keep ultimate power with the people, directly or through chosen representatives, which is why both are democracies. A hereditary monarch holding ultimate power would be a monarchy, not a democracy. Forbidding citizens to vote contradicts the very idea of democracy. Requiring religious approval of every decision describes a theocracy, not either kind of democracy.

21. (C) With one party, obedient courts and criminalised criticism, power is unchecked and the people cannot really choose or remove rulers, so it is a dictatorship behind democratic words. A scheduled vote with no real choice does not make a genuine democracy. Being a republic concerns only an elected head of state and does not guarantee the missing pillars. Casting a ballot for the sole party is not citizens deciding issues themselves, so it is not a direct democracy.

22. (A) X has the full set of democratic pillars while Y has only the outward vote, so X is more truly a democracy. Elections alone are not the complete test, so Y is not the answer. Holding elections on a schedule does not make the two equal when one lacks every other pillar. Democracy permits organised parties; in fact Y's banning of rival parties is itself undemocratic, so 'neither' is wrong.

23. (D) Even an elected majority is bound by rule of law and the constitution, and protected rights cannot be stripped by a vote, which is the correct response. A majority does not free leaders from legal limits, so the first option states the very misconception being refuted. The constitution itself, not only the courts, sets binding limits, so the second is wrong. Elections do not suspend fundamental rights, so the last option is false.

24. (C) Democracy is majority rule limited by protected rights, so the assertion is false while the reason is incomplete rather than simply true. The assertion is not true, so the first option fails. Democracy does involve majority decisions, so 'no majority decisions at all' is wrong. The majority does play a role in democracy, so the claim that it never involves the majority is also wrong.

25. (A) Putting the courts under the ruling party destroys judicial independence, moving the country away from democracy. Extending the vote to every adult strengthens democracy. Guaranteeing free criticism strengthens democracy. Allowing independent courts to overturn unlawful actions strengthens democracy. Only the first weakens it.

26. (D) Rights, an independent court and equality are all present, so the missing pillar is the people's power to choose and remove rulers through free and fair elections. Free speech is guaranteed, so that pillar is present. The independent judiciary is described as able to check the government, so it is present. Equality is guaranteed, so it too is present; only elections are absent.

27. (B) Denying one community the vote and office breaks equality of citizens, the principle that everyone counts the same in choosing the government. Separation of powers concerns how the organs are arranged, not who may vote, so it is not the violation. An elected head of state is the republic feature and is unaffected here. Democracy does not require a referendum on every law, so that is not the violated principle.

28. (C) Accountability means the government answers to its electors and can be voted out, a check absent in a dictatorship. Being free from all questioning is the opposite of accountability. Answering only to a foreign power is not accountability to one's own people. Overruling the courts at will would defeat the checks that make accountability real, so that misdescribes it.

29. (C) Seizing absolute, unchecked power makes this a dictatorship, and monarchy is wrong because it specifically means inherited family rule, which did not happen. Not every all-powerful single ruler is a monarch, since monarchy requires inheritance. Nothing here

rests on a religious claim, so theocracy does not fit. The power is held by one person, not a group, so oligarchy is also wrong.

30. (B) Both concentrate unchecked power in one person without accountability or legal limits, which is their core similarity despite an absolute monarch inheriting and a dictator often seizing power. Neither is chosen by universal franchise. Neither keeps the ruler merely ceremonial under an elected body, since both rulers actually govern. Neither steps down at a court's ruling, because both reject such limits.

31. (B) Rule by a small wealthy group is an oligarchy and rule by one unchecked person is a dictatorship, so the order is oligarchy then dictatorship, distinguished by group versus single ruler. The first distractor reverses the order. Neither has an elected head of state or a nominal monarch, so republic and constitutional monarchy do not fit. Neither rests on religious law or citizens voting on issues, so theocracy and direct democracy are wrong.

32. (A) An absolute monarch, a dictator and an oligarchy all concentrate power in one or a few rulers, so that set fits. The first distractor lists only people-centred forms, which spread power rather than concentrate it. The second mixes in direct democracy and constitutional monarchy, both of which keep power with the people or an elected parliament. The third mixes in a republic and representative democracy, which are people-centred.

33. (D) Rule by clerics applying sacred law is a theocracy, so 'oligarchy', which means rule by a small usually wealthy group rather than by religion, is the odd one out. 'Theocracy' is the exact term and fits. 'Religious leaders hold authority' restates a theocracy. 'Sacred law overrides ordinary lawmaking' also describes a theocracy, so only oligarchy does not belong.

34. (B) Oligarchy combines roots meaning 'few' and 'rule', matching rule by a small group. Monarchy means rule by one, not many. Democracy means power of the people, not 'god' plus power. Theocracy means rule by god or religion, not 'one' plus rule, so only the oligarchy pairing is right.

35. (B) Speed does not define democracy; accountability and the people's power to choose and remove rulers do, all of which a dictatorship lacks, so it is no kind of democracy. Speed is not the defining feature, so the first option is wrong. A staged election under unchecked power still is not genuine democracy, so the second fails. A dictatorship is not a constitutional monarchy, which has a nominal monarch and an elected parliament.

36. (D) Drift toward oligarchy means a small powerful group captures real control while ordinary votes lose effect, which is the signal. Higher turnout strengthens, not weakens, the people's role. Greater judicial independence is a democratic safeguard, not a drift toward oligarchy. Better-protected rights strengthen democracy, so none of those signal the drift.

37. (A) A dictatorship reliably lacks genuine accountability and the people's power to replace rulers by election, which a democracy has. A capital city, armed forces and national symbols can all exist under a dictatorship just as under a democracy, so none of those is the distinguishing absence.

38. (C) Genuine democracy needs the full set: free and fair elections, equality, protected rights and an independent judiciary together. An army, long history and single ruling family describe concentrated, possibly hereditary power, not democracy. Votes without rights or courts is the very hollow case democracy must exceed. Rule by clergy is a theocracy, not a democracy.

39. (D) A nominal queen who cannot refuse laws, with an elected, answerable parliament governing, is a constitutional monarchy that is also a parliamentary democracy. Signing laws she cannot refuse is ceremonial, not absolute rule. An elected, answerable parliament governs, so it is not a dictatorship. Ceremonial reverence is not religious rule, so it is not a theocracy.

40. (C) A constitutional monarchy is exactly a country that is both a monarchy and a democracy, and the nominal monarch with an elected parliament is precisely why, so both are true and the reason explains the assertion. The reason does explain the assertion, so 'does not explain' is wrong. The reason is a true description of a constitutional monarchy, so it is not false. The assertion is true, so 'false' is wrong.

41. (B) A king who really makes laws, commands the army and judges, unchecked, is an absolute monarch, not a constitutional one, where the monarch is nominal under an elected parliament. Having a king does not automatically make a monarchy constitutional. A republic has an elected, non-hereditary head, not a ruling king, so that fails. One person deciding everything is the opposite of citizens deciding, so it is not a direct democracy.

42. (A) The UK is a democracy because the elected parliament governs while the monarch is merely nominal. The monarch is not secretly elected; the monarchy is hereditary. The monarch does not make the laws; parliament does. Merely having a monarch does not make a country democratic, as absolute monarchies show, so the last option is false.

43. (A) Lawmaking is legislative, carrying out is executive and settling disputes is judicial, so the first option is the correct match. The second wrongly hands enforcement to the legislature, dispute-settling to the executive and lawmaking to the judiciary. The third scrambles the roles in a different wrong order. The fourth ignores that only one organ makes laws.

44. (C) Judging whether an act is lawful is the judicial function, distinct from the executive, which carries out laws rather than judging them. Striking down an unlawful order is applying existing law, not writing new law, so it is not legislative. The court is

checking, not enforcing, the government's will, so it is not executive. The ruling has real legal effect, so it is not merely ceremonial.

45. (A) Separating power into three independent, mutually checking organs prevents any one leader from dominating. Letting one leader appoint the judges and control lawmaking concentrates power instead of dividing it. Abolishing the courts removes a key check, easing domination. Putting the army over the legislature and judiciary again concentrates power, so only the first design meets the goal.

46. (A) Spanning India, Greece and Rome, the examples show that choosing rulers is an ancient idea appearing across civilisations. They contradict the notion that democracy is a modern twenty-first-century invention. They show more than one civilisation tried self-rule. They show elections were possible long before modern times, refuting the last claim.

47. (D) The Lichchhavis were part of the Vajji confederation, showing that leaders were chosen, not merely inherited, in ancient India. The Mauryan Magadha was a monarchy of inherited kings, a different example. The Uttaramerur records belong to the Cholas, not the Lichchhavis. The Kushanas were a separate northwestern empire, unrelated to the Lichchhavi example.

48. (C) The Uttaramerur inscriptions record an organised local election system, proving such elections existed in early India. They therefore contradict the claim that India had no elections before modern times. They show power was not always purely hereditary. And they place elections in India, not only in Greece, refuting the last option.

49. (A) An elected, non-hereditary head of state makes it a republic, while crushed opposition and criticism mean it falls short of genuine democracy, so both of those are true. Electing a head does not by itself make a democracy when freedoms are crushed, and a republic does not require a king, so the first option errs twice. A republic has no monarch, so it is not a constitutional monarchy, and it is not a full democracy. Voting for one head is not citizens deciding every issue, and jailing critics is not religious rule, so the last option fails.

50. (D) R's elected parliament under a nominal monarch is a democracy, and S's elected, non-hereditary head of state is a republic, so neither claim holds; the strength of a president has no bearing on whether the head is elected. The first option simply restates the misconceptions. A republic is defined by an elected head, not a weak one, so the second is wrong. Representative democracies are still democracies, so the last option is false.

51. (A) When a small wealthy circle truly decides policy whatever the vote, real power rests with the few, which is an oligarchy wearing democratic dress. Free elections and protected speech are not enough if a small group controls the outcomes, so it is not a healthy democracy. There is no monarch, so it is not a constitutional monarchy. Citizens

casting ballots for representatives is not direct democracy, especially when the few decide policy.

52. (D) An army that can overrule any court wipes out judicial independence and rule of law, undermining the democracy claim. An elected head of state actually supports the republic claim, so it is no contradiction. Parliament making laws supports the democracy claim. Speed of dispute-settling is not the defining feature of democracy, so the last option is mistaken about both the fact and the contradiction.

53. (B) A presidential system needs a separately elected head of government on a fixed term, while keeping the head of state elected preserves the republic, so making it hereditary must be avoided. Making the head hereditary and ending elections would destroy both the republic and the democracy, so the first distractor is self-defeating. Abolishing the legislature and the judiciary would end the democracy he wants to keep. Handing all power to one person and banning criticism would create a dictatorship, not a presidential democracy.

54. (C) Answering to an assembly, being removable and obeying courts versus none of these is the difference of accountability under rule of law. Population size has no bearing on whether rulers are accountable. Both kinds of state can have armies, so that is not the divider. A country's age does not determine accountability, so that too is wrong.

55. (D) J's hereditary head makes it a monarchy, and its elected parliament with courts that can check ministers makes it a democracy, so it is a constitutional-monarchy democracy; K's elected head makes it a republic, but a single party and obedient courts deny it genuine democracy. J has a hereditary head, so it is not a republic, and K's controlled courts mean it is not a full democracy, defeating the first and second options. K has an elected head, not a monarch, and J is not absolute since parliament governs, so those parts also fail. Not both are republics, since J has a hereditary head, so the last option is wrong.

56. (D) Monarchy is defined by hereditary succession within the family, which the other three do not feature. An oligarchy is rule by a small group, not necessarily a single inherited bloodline. A republic's head of state is elected, not handed to an heir. In a representative democracy seats are won by election, not inherited, so only monarchy fits the description.

57. (A) A scheduled vote alongside jailed critics, banned rivals and captured courts shows elections without the other pillars are not enough, proving 'not sufficient'. Open opposition that sometimes wins shows a working democracy, not insufficiency. Independent courts overturning unlawful acts is a democratic strength, not a failing. Equal rights for minorities is also a democratic strength, so only the first shows the elections-alone shortfall.

58. (D) The chapter concludes that despite its flaws democracy is the most popular form of government in the world today. It is widely used, so it is not the rarest. Many countries practise it, so it is not unused. It protects rights and accountability that a dictatorship lacks, so it is not identical to a dictatorship.

59. (D) People choosing and removing rulers under rights is a democracy, a hereditary king governing unchecked is an absolute monarchy, one seized unlimited leader is a dictatorship, and five families controlling everything is an oligarchy, so W-X-Y-Z map exactly that way. The other options scramble these: rule by the people is not an oligarchy or dictatorship, an unchecked king is not a democracy or republic, a seized unlimited ruler is not a democracy, and a five-family clique is not a democracy or theocracy.

60. (A) An elected head and regular votes make it a republic, but a majority removing protected rights with no check shows democracy is failing, because fundamental rights cannot be voted away. A majority cannot lawfully pass any law it wishes, so it is not a full democracy on that basis. A republic does not forbid the majority from deciding; it just requires an elected head of state. Holding regular elections is not proof of dictatorship, so the last option is wrong.